

ALPHA REALISM

The Prompt Test That Breaks Realism

Five prompts that prove perfection is why your AI images look fake.

Perfection is the fingerprint of AI.
Reality lives in the flaws.

COPY ANY PROMPT — YOU'LL GET A DIFFERENT FACE, BUT THE SAME "REAL PHOTO" FEELING.

Flyaway Hair

Loose strands catch the light — the tell of a real photo, not a render.

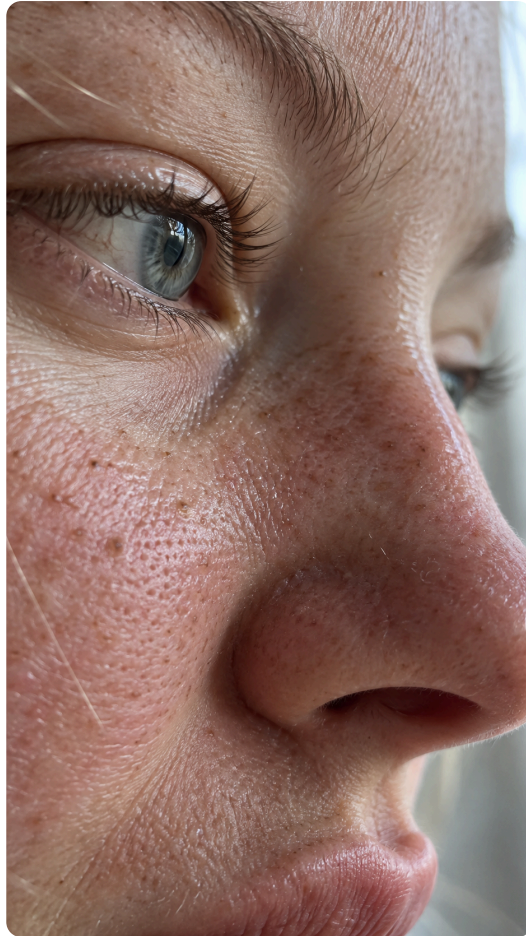


COPY THIS PROMPT →

Documentary-style head-and-shoulders portrait, vertical 3:4 composition, depicting an ordinary person with open identity, without specifying hair color, eye color, skin tone, age, or gender. The subject stands beside a window in an ordinary living room, maintaining a relaxed, natural posture while looking toward or just past the camera, without a studio pose. The primary evidence of realism is the presence of individual loose hair strands (flyaways) physically separated from the main hair mass, naturally lifted by subtle air movement near the window. Some strands intersect the backlit edge of the head, while others lightly touch the face. Fine frizz is irregularly distributed, following the natural behavior of thin hair fibers under gentle airflow, with no artificial symmetry. The skin preserves its natural microstructure, showing visible pores, subtle tonal variation, minor imperfections, faint physiological sheen, and slight natural facial asymmetry, with no cosmetic enhancement or skin smoothing. Expression is neutral or quietly contemplative, without exaggerated emotion. Illumination is produced primarily by overcast daylight entering laterally through the window. The large diffuse light source creates low overall contrast, broad soft shadows, smooth tonal transitions, and an absence of harsh specular highlights. Fill light originates only from natural reflections within the room, preserving the authentic luminance hierarchy. The setting is an ordinary living room containing everyday household clutter, casually arranged without deliberate styling. The background remains slightly out of focus, preserving spatial context while avoiding visual distraction. Captured with a 50 mm full-frame equivalent lens, shallow depth of field, precise focus on the eyes and facial plane. Natural optical vignetting, subtle lens imperfections, light luminance noise, moderate microcontrast, no skin smoothing, no sharpening, no HDR, no beauty retouching, no AI-enhanced textures, preserving the authentic limitations of optics, sensor response, image processing, and compression typical of a documentary photograph. --ar 3:4

Skin Texture

Pores and micro-relief at macro scale. Reality lives in the flaws.



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Macro close-focus observation of ordinary human facial skin with identity intentionally unconstrained. The scene is illuminated by overcast daylight transmitted through a side window and softened further by diffuse interior reflections. The dominant side illumination establishes the luminance hierarchy before chromatic perception, producing low global contrast, gradual shadow occupancy within pores and skin furrows, and localized highlights where a spatially varying lipid film increases Fresnel reflectance across the T-zone. Skin is reconstructed as a layered biological medium: irregular follicular openings, intersecting primary and secondary skin furrows, variable stratum corneum thickness, uneven pore diameters, isolated corneocyte flaking, fine randomly oriented vellus hairs, superficial vascular networks producing increased hemoglobin coloration near the alar region, and subsurface transport through epidermis and dermis softening penumbral transitions without recovering occluded detail. A true macro lens images the skin at close focus with an extremely shallow depth of field, slight field curvature, mild longitudinal chromatic aberration on high-contrast hair boundaries, gradual loss of microcontrast outside the focal plane, and natural optical falloff. Exposure is calibrated to preserve skin luminance while allowing gentle approach toward sensor saturation on illuminated regions without abrupt clipping. Sensor response includes photon shot noise within darker tonal regions, standard demosaicing, minimal local contrast enhancement, weak edge sharpening, no skin smoothing, no HDR fusion, and no AI texture reconstruction, preserving naturally occurring biological microstructure rather than idealized surface appearance.

Asymmetry

Real faces are uneven. Perfect symmetry is the fingerprint of AI.



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Front-facing 3:4 portrait of an ordinary person with an open identity, framed from the head to the upper shoulders, relaxed posture with a slight natural head tilt. Identity emerges from preserved biological asymmetries: one eye resting subtly higher than the other, slight difference in tension at the corners of the mouth, jaw positioned slightly off the facial midline, natural left-right facial asymmetry, with no geometric alignment or correction. Neutral, spontaneous expression without an idealized pose. Skin retains real texture with visible pores, fine natural irregularities, continuous tonal transitions, and no skin smoothing. Hair behaves naturally, with loose strands, subtle misalignment, and physically plausible variation in strand direction. Illumination is produced by an overcast sky acting as a large diffuse light source, creating very soft shadows, low global contrast, smooth luminance transitions, and no dramatic lighting or artificial fill. Captured with a 50 mm equivalent lens, natural perspective, moderate depth of field, precise focus on the eyes, subtle optical vignetting toward the frame edges, and light sensor noise consistent with a documentary-style daylight capture, preserving surface texture without a plastic appearance. Neutral color rendering with natural overcast daylight white balance, moderate contrast, no computational beautification, no facial harmonization, no symmetry correction, no skin smoothing, no aesthetic retouching, and no idealization. The final image should preserve the normal anatomical variability of a real human face, where subtle structural imperfections remain intact as an essential part of the subject's identity.

Lens Artifacts

Vignette, aberration, soft edges — a real lens leaves marks.



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Portrait, 3:4 aspect ratio, of an ordinary person with open identity, standing beside a daylight window. The scene is defined primarily by physically plausible lens behavior rather than stylistic enhancement. Soft optical vignetting gradually darkens the corners. Subtle lateral chromatic aberration appears only along high-contrast edges, especially where the bright window frame meets the darker background. Natural edge softness from field curvature and lens performance reduces sharpness toward the frame perimeter. The focal plane is precisely on the nearest eye, while the far eye and distant side of the face fall slightly out of focus due to shallow depth of field. A faint veiling glare forms near the window light source from internal lens reflections without overwhelming contrast. Daylight enters through the window with realistic luminance distribution and gentle shadow transitions. Skin retains visible pores, fine texture, and natural tonal variation. Loose flyaway hairs remain individually resolved. Subtle luminance and chroma noise is present in shadow regions, consistent with a real digital camera sensor. No skin smoothing, no beauty retouching, no artificial sharpening, no HDR look, no excessive micro-contrast, no cinematic grading. Documentary realism, physically accurate optics, authentic sensor response, natural material behavior, faithful exposure. --ar 3:4

Atmospheric Depth

Humidity scatters light. Distance fades into haze.



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Environmental portrait, wider 3:4 composition, of an ordinary person with open identity in an outdoor urban environment under humid, overcast weather. Primary physical evidence: atmospheric depth created by moisture in the air—humidity increases forward scattering of distant light, causing buildings and trees in the background to progressively lose local contrast and shift toward a brighter mist-like luminance, forming a smooth atmospheric perspective gradient receding behind the subject. The subject remains in slightly higher local contrast against the softened distance. Diffuse overcast skylight provides soft, omnidirectional illumination with no direct sunlight or hard shadows. Natural skin microtexture preserved, loose flyaway hairs responding to ambient air movement. Documentary realism with no beautification. 35mm lens, moderate depth of field, subtle sensor noise, physically plausible exposure, natural optical rendering. No color grading, no HDR tonal lifting, no cinematic look, no artificial contrast enhancement, no excessive sharpening. Neutral white balance, authentic material response, realistic atmospheric scattering, physically accurate light transport. Aspect ratio 3:4.

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50+ terms and exactly how to use them —
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